

DOC 1 — VOCABULARY IN CONTEXT: 80 QUESTIONS

Digital SAT Reading & Writing Practice Set

Skill: Vocabulary in Context (Words in Context)

Stem Types:

- "Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?"
- "As used in the text, what does the word '____' most nearly mean?"

Difficulty Distribution: ~24 Easy | ~32 Medium | ~24 Hard

Domain Mix: Science • Social Science • Literature • History

Q1. [Easy]

Komodo dragons were long thought to kill prey through bacteria-laden bites that caused fatal infections. However, in 2009 researcher Bryan Fry and colleagues discovered that Komodo dragons possess venom glands in their lower jaws, a finding that _____ the bacterial-infection hypothesis by providing an alternative explanation for the rapid decline of bitten prey.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) validated
 - B) publicized
 - C) replicated
 - D) undermined
-

Q2. [Easy]

Certain species of fireflies synchronize their flashing patterns so precisely that entire swarms blink in unison. Biologist Marta Selenko has argued that this coordinated behavior is not merely decorative but _____ a clear purpose: helping individual fireflies locate mates more efficiently against the visual noise of a dark forest.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) obscures
 - B) serves
 - C) disputes
 - D) abandons
-

Q3. [Easy]

Ocean temperatures in the Arctic have risen more rapidly than in other regions, causing sea ice to retreat at alarming rates. Climatologist Priya Deshpande notes that this accelerated warming has had a measurable _____ on polar bear hunting ranges, forcing the animals to travel greater distances to reach stable ice platforms.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) relief
 - B) luxury
 - C) approval
 - D) impact
-

Q4. [Easy]

Economist Layla Osman has observed that microfinance programs in rural areas often produce results that _____ the expectations of their designers. While program architects typically predict steady, incremental growth in borrowers' incomes, many participants instead experience erratic fluctuations driven by seasonal agricultural cycles.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) defy
 - B) confirm
 - C) echo
 - D) celebrate
-

Q5. [Easy]

In her analysis of urban transportation networks, sociologist Carmen Iglesias found that cities with extensive subway systems tend to have lower rates of traffic congestion than cities that rely primarily on buses. Her findings _____ the widely held view that underground rail reduces surface-level vehicle crowding.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) reject
 - B) confuse
 - C) exaggerate
 - D) support
-

Q6. [Easy]

The following text is adapted from a 1903 short story by Amara Okonkwo. The narrator describes a visit to her grandmother's garden.

The rows of tomato plants stood in perfect formation, each stalk tied to its post with careful precision. My grandmother surveyed her work with quiet satisfaction, adjusting a single wayward vine before stepping back to take in the full picture. She ran her garden the way she ran everything else—with an iron will and a gentle hand.

As used in the text, what does the word "ran" most nearly mean?

- A) Sprinted through

- B) Managed
 - C) Dissolved
 - D) Advertised
-

Q7. [Easy]

The following text is adapted from Tomás Herrera's 1948 novel *The Copper Bell*. The narrator describes a bustling town square.

The marketplace hummed with the sharp cries of vendors and the shuffle of hurrying feet. A woman balanced a tower of clay pots on her head, weaving between stalls with practiced ease. The air was thick with the scent of roasting corn and fresh cilantro. For all its chaos, the square had a rhythm that any regular visitor could feel.

As used in the text, what does the word "thick" most nearly mean?

- A) Dense
 - B) Wide
 - C) Stupid
 - D) Solid
-

Q8. [Easy]

The construction of the transcontinental railroad in the 1860s dramatically _____ travel times across the United States. A journey from New York to San Francisco that had previously taken months by wagon or ship could now be completed in less than a week by train.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) extended
 - B) invented
 - C) ignored
 - D) reduced
-

Q9. [Easy]

During the Renaissance, the city-state of Florence became a center for artistic innovation. Wealthy families such as the Visconti and the Salviati _____ artists by commissioning paintings, sculptures, and architectural projects, ensuring that talented creators had the financial resources to pursue their work.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) patronized
 - B) penalized
 - C) abandoned
 - D) imitated
-

Q10. [Easy]

The fruit of the baobab tree, sometimes called "monkey bread," contains high concentrations of vitamin C and antioxidants. Nutritionist Kenji Watanabe argues that baobab fruit could help _____ vitamin deficiencies in communities where access to fresh produce is limited, since the fruit can be dried and stored for long periods without losing its nutritional value.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) address
 - B) intensify
 - C) overlook
 - D) mimic
-

Q11. [Easy]

Psychologist Rina Gupta found that students who studied in short, focused intervals performed better on memory tests than students who studied for extended, uninterrupted periods. Her results _____ the common belief that longer study sessions are always more productive.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) illustrate
 - B) restore
 - C) adopt
 - D) contradict
-

Q12. [Easy]

The following text is adapted from Nadia Petrov's 1955 novel *Winter Crossing*. The narrator describes a conversation with her father.

He delivered the news without ceremony, as though he were reading a list of groceries rather than announcing the family's departure from the only home we had ever known. His voice carried no weight of sadness, no tremor of regret. I searched his face for some crack in the composure, but he had sealed himself shut.

As used in the text, what does the word "weight" most nearly mean?

- A) Heaviness
 - B) Burden
 - C) Measurement
 - D) Importance
-

Q13. [Easy]

Coral reefs support roughly 25 percent of all known marine species despite occupying less than one percent of the ocean floor. Marine biologist Hana Yoshida describes reefs as _____ ecosystems, noting that even minor disturbances—such as slight increases in water temperature—can trigger widespread bleaching events that devastate entire reef communities.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) fragile
 - B) resilient
 - C) artificial
 - D) permanent
-

Q14. [Easy]

Historian Dalton Ngozi argues that the spread of the printing press in fifteenth-century Europe did not immediately make books _____ to the general public. Although printing reduced production costs, books remained expensive relative to average wages for several decades after the technology's introduction.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) invisible
 - B) identical
 - C) controversial
 - D) affordable
-

Q15. [Easy]

Ancient Egyptian physicians documented treatments for various ailments on papyrus scrolls, creating some of the earliest known medical texts. These records reveal that Egyptian healers possessed a surprisingly _____ understanding of human anatomy, including knowledge of the heart's role in circulating blood through the body.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) superficial
 - B) reluctant
 - C) sophisticated
 - D) fictional
-

Q16. [Easy]

The following text is adapted from Celeste Moreau's 1932 novel *The Orchard Path*. The narrator recalls a childhood summer.

Every evening, Aunt Margaux would plant herself in the wicker chair on the porch and hold court, dispensing opinions on the neighbors' gardens, the weather, and the state of the nation with equal authority. No one dared interrupt her; she commanded the conversation the way a general commands a regiment.

As used in the text, what does the word "court" most nearly mean?

- A) A legal tribunal
 - B) A royal assembly
 - C) An audience
 - D) A sports arena
-

Q17. [Easy]

Researchers studying sleep patterns in adolescents have found that early school start times often _____ students' natural circadian rhythms, which tend to shift toward later bedtimes and wake times during puberty. As a result, many teenagers arrive at school already fatigued.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) align with
 - B) contribute to
 - C) originate from
 - D) conflict with
-

Q18. [Easy]

The following text is adapted from Julian Hargrove's 1961 novel *The Watchmaker's Daughter*. The narrator describes the family workshop.

My father's hands moved with a precision that I could only marvel at. Each tiny gear, each spring no bigger than an eyelash, found its place under his steady fingers. He never rushed. The work demanded patience, and he gave it freely, treating each watch as though it were the only one in the world.

As used in the text, what does the word "demanded" most nearly mean?

- A) Ordered aggressively
 - B) Requested formally
 - C) Required
 - D) Questioned
-

Q19. [Easy]

Archaeologist Fatima al-Rashid discovered that ancient Mesopotamian traders used standardized clay tokens to record commercial transactions. These tokens _____ an early form of bookkeeping, predating written language by thousands of years.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) represented
- B) destroyed
- C) concealed
- D) delayed

Q20. [Easy]

The population of monarch butterflies that migrates annually from Canada to central Mexico has declined sharply over the past two decades. Conservationist Elara Voss attributes this decline primarily to the _____ of milkweed, the only plant on which monarchs lay their eggs, from farmlands where herbicide use has become widespread.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) discovery
 - B) decoration
 - C) cultivation
 - D) disappearance
-

Q21. [Easy]

In her study of early childhood language acquisition, linguist Saoirse Byrne found that bilingual toddlers often _____ between languages within a single sentence, a phenomenon known as code-switching. Rather than indicating confusion, this behavior demonstrates a sophisticated awareness of grammatical rules in both languages.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) alternate
 - B) struggle
 - C) hesitate
 - D) compete
-

Q22. [Easy]

The following text is adapted from Rosa Medina's 1978 short story collection *Salt and Stone*. The narrator describes her grandfather's woodworking shop.

The shop was a kingdom of sawdust and varnish, every surface covered in curls of pale wood. Grandfather kept his tools in strict order—chisels ranked by size along the wall, saws hanging from iron hooks, sandpaper stacked in neat columns. He tolerated no disorder. Even a misplaced pencil could draw a sharp look from those dark, watchful eyes.

As used in the text, what does the word "draw" most nearly mean?

- A) Sketch
 - B) Pull
 - C) Provoke
 - D) Illustrate
-

Q23. [Easy]

The ancient Romans constructed an extensive network of roads stretching across their empire, many of which remain partially intact today. Historian Marcus Chen notes that this infrastructure _____ not only military movement but also trade and cultural exchange between distant provinces.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) prohibited
 - B) facilitated
 - C) criticized
 - D) memorized
-

Q24. [Easy]

Though many people associate deserts exclusively with extreme heat, nighttime temperatures in some desert regions can drop below freezing. This dramatic temperature _____ between day and night occurs because dry desert air lacks the moisture needed to retain heat after sunset.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) similarity
 - B) average
 - C) swing
 - D) ceiling
-

Q25. [Medium]

Geologist Ayesha Farooq has argued that conventional models of volcanic eruption prediction rely too heavily on seismic data alone. She contends that integrating satellite-based measurements of ground deformation would significantly _____ the accuracy of these models, since subtle surface changes often precede eruptions by weeks or months.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) bolster
 - B) replicate
 - C) diminish
 - D) postpone
-

Q26. [Medium]

Musicologist Ravi Shankar Iyer has observed that the sitar, though often perceived in Western countries as a purely traditional instrument, has undergone considerable _____ over the past century. Modern sitars feature steel strings, moveable frets, and resonating chambers that differ markedly from those of their eighteenth-century predecessors.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) neglect
 - B) preservation
 - C) modification
 - D) censorship
-

Q27. [Medium]

Political scientist Nkechi Adeyemi notes that voter turnout in municipal elections is typically far lower than in national contests. She attributes this _____ partly to a widespread misconception that local government decisions have little effect on residents' daily lives, when in fact municipal policies shape everything from zoning regulations to public school funding.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) disparity
 - B) surplus
 - C) uniformity
 - D) incentive
-

Q28. [Medium]

The following text is adapted from Kaede Nakamura's 1965 novel *The Paper Lantern*. The narrator recounts attending a ceremony.

The old priest spoke in a voice so low that the gathered mourners had to strain forward to catch his words. Each syllable fell like a pebble into still water, sending ripples of silence through the crowd. Even the children, usually restless at such events, were arrested by the gravity of the moment.

As used in the text, what does the word "arrested" most nearly mean?

- A) Detained by police
 - B) Halted
 - C) Accused
 - D) Frightened
-

Q29. [Medium]

Although the axolotl, a salamander native to Mexico's Lake Xochimilco, is critically endangered in the wild, it _____ in laboratory settings worldwide. Scientists prize the species for its extraordinary ability to regenerate lost limbs, making it an invaluable model organism for regenerative medicine research.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) deteriorates
- B) competes
- C) hides
- D) thrives

Q30. [Medium]

Linguist Yuki Tanaka has found that speakers of tone languages—languages like Mandarin, in which pitch changes alter a word's meaning—tend to have a heightened ability to _____ subtle differences in musical pitch. This finding suggests a link between linguistic experience and auditory perception.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) discern
 - B) generate
 - C) disregard
 - D) broadcast
-

Q31. [Medium]

The following text is adapted from Eloise Germaine's 1927 novella *The Linen Room*. The narrator describes her employer, Mrs. Whitfield.

Mrs. Whitfield was not unkind, but she practiced a rigid economy in all things, including affection. Praise from her was so rare that when it arrived, it carried the force of a proclamation. The household staff lived under a regime of efficiency and silence, and any lapse—a wrinkled tablecloth, a smudged window—was met with a look that could wither flowers.

As used in the text, what does the word "economy" most nearly mean?

- A) Financial system
 - B) Bargain
 - C) Restraint
 - D) Wealth
-

Q32. [Medium]

Architect Lucía Reyes argues that the trend toward glass-walled office buildings in tropical cities is fundamentally misguided. In hot climates, extensive glass facades dramatically increase cooling costs and energy consumption, _____ the very sustainability goals that many of these buildings' developers publicly champion.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) advancing
 - B) illustrating
 - C) undermining
 - D) measuring
-

Q33. [Medium]

Despite their reputation as solitary predators, recent studies have revealed that some leopard populations display unexpectedly _____ behavior. In Kenya's Laikipia Plateau, wildlife biologist Amani Okafor documented instances of adult males sharing kills with unrelated females and tolerating the presence of neighboring males at water sources.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) aggressive
 - B) territorial
 - C) social
 - D) predatory
-

Q34. [Medium]

Economist Miriam Osei-Bonsu contends that policies designed to _____ urban sprawl—such as higher-density zoning requirements and investments in public transit—often face resistance from suburban homeowners who fear that increased density will reduce their property values.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) curtail
 - B) promote
 - C) define
 - D) disguise
-

Q35. [Medium]

The following text is adapted from Dmitri Volkov's 1951 novel *The Amber Coast*. The narrator describes a chess match.

Krupov studied the board with the patience of a man who had nowhere else to be. He lifted his knight, held it suspended over the board for a long moment, then returned it to its original square. The gesture was deliberate—a feint, designed to rattle his opponent. Across the table, Petrov's jaw tightened almost imperceptibly.

As used in the text, what does the word "deliberate" most nearly mean?

- A) Slow
 - B) Accidental
 - C) Obvious
 - D) Intentional
-

Q36. [Medium]

Historian Claudette Benoit has argued that the popular narrative of the French Revolution as a sudden eruption of popular rage oversimplifies a far more _____ process. Years of crop failures, fiscal mismanagement, and philosophical debate had gradually eroded confidence in the monarchy long before the storming of the Bastille.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) instantaneous
 - B) secretive
 - C) entertaining
 - D) gradual
-

Q37. [Medium]

Neuroscientist Liora Stern's research has revealed that chronic sleep deprivation does not merely cause fatigue but also impairs the brain's ability to consolidate memories. Her findings suggest that the effects of prolonged sleeplessness are _____ previously understood: rather than a simple lack of energy, the consequences include measurable cognitive decline.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) more extensive than
 - B) less significant than
 - C) identical to what was
 - D) unrelated to what was
-

Q38. [Medium]

Urban planner Takeshi Morimoto found that neighborhoods with abundant street trees experience significantly lower summer temperatures than those without tree cover. The shade and evapotranspiration provided by mature trees can _____ the urban heat island effect, which occurs when concrete and asphalt absorb and radiate solar energy.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) mitigate
 - B) intensify
 - C) replicate
 - D) inaugurate
-

Q39. [Medium]

The following text is adapted from Anya Krishnamurthy's 2004 novel *The Spice Merchant's Ledger*. The narrator describes a marketplace negotiation.

My uncle conducted his haggling with a theatrical flair that delighted onlookers and infuriated his rivals. He would gasp at a price as though personally wounded, clutch his chest, declare himself ruined—then, just as the seller began to soften, he would press his advantage with ruthless precision. His performance was as polished as any actor's.

As used in the text, what does the word "press" most nearly mean?

- A) Iron

- B) Publish
 - C) Push
 - D) Squeeze
-

Q40. [Medium]

Sociologist Anika Hoffman argues that the digital divide—the gap between those who have access to modern information technology and those who do not—cannot be addressed solely through the distribution of devices. Without adequate training and technical support, she notes, donated laptops and tablets often go unused, leaving the underlying _____ in digital literacy unresolved.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) surplus
 - B) trend
 - C) innovation
 - D) dearth
-

Q41. [Medium]

Despite being one of the most prolific composers of the Baroque era, Georg Philipp Telemann has long been overshadowed by his contemporary Johann Sebastian Bach. Music historian Elara Kowalski argues that this _____ is unwarranted, pointing out that Telemann's works were more widely performed during his lifetime and that his innovations in orchestral form influenced generations of later composers.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) collaboration
 - B) celebrity
 - C) neglect
 - D) imitation
-

Q42. [Medium]

Ecologist Tara Mackenzie has documented the phenomenon of "ecological traps," in which animals are attracted to environments that appear suitable but are actually harmful. For instance, some species of sea turtles mistake the glow of coastal development for moonlight reflecting off the ocean, a confusion that _____ hatchlings away from the sea and toward dangerous roads and buildings.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) lures
 - B) shields
 - C) releases
 - D) distinguishes
-

Q43. [Medium]

The following text is adapted from Samuel Ogunlimu's 1989 novel *The Indigo Hour*. The narrator describes his father's reaction to unexpected news.

My father received the letter in silence, his expression betraying nothing. He folded it twice with mechanical precision and placed it inside his coat pocket. Only when he turned toward the window did I notice the almost imperceptible tremor in his hand—a small fissure in the composure he wore like armor.

As used in the text, what does the word "wore" most nearly mean?

- A) Eroded
 - B) Displayed
 - C) Purchased
 - D) Damaged
-

Q44. [Medium]

Paleontologist Haruto Ito challenges the popular image of *Tyrannosaurus rex* as an exclusively active predator. Ito's analysis of bone isotopes suggests that *T. rex* may have been partly _____, supplementing its diet by scavenging the carcasses of animals killed by other predators or natural causes, much as modern hyenas do.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) herbivorous
 - B) aquatic
 - C) nocturnal
 - D) opportunistic
-

Q45. [Medium]

Cognitive psychologist Mei-Ling Zhou found that people who were asked to evaluate the credibility of news articles while multitasking were significantly more likely to accept false claims as true than people who evaluated the same articles without distractions. Her results underscore the idea that critical thinking requires _____ attention.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) sustained
 - B) divided
 - C) fleeting
 - D) peripheral
-

Q46. [Medium]

The ancient Incan practice of using quipus—knotted strings of varying colors and lengths—to record information has long puzzled researchers. While most scholars agree that quipus served as numerical

record-keeping devices, anthropologist Daniela Fuentes contends that their function was far more _____, arguing that certain knot patterns may have encoded narratives and historical accounts.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) limited
 - B) conventional
 - C) obsolete
 - D) expansive
-

Q47. [Medium]

The following text is adapted from Irene Castellanos's 1971 novel *Saltwater*. The narrator recalls a visit to her aunt's coastal home.

Aunt Viviana was a woman of formidable opinions. She dismissed most modern conveniences as frivolous and cooked every meal over a wood fire, regarding the gas stove in her kitchen as an unwelcome intruder. Yet for all her stubbornness, she harbored a single, surprising concession to modernity: a small transistor radio that she kept on the windowsill, tuned perpetually to a station playing boleros.

As used in the text, what does the word "harbored" most nearly mean?

- A) Sheltered ships
 - B) Maintained
 - C) Suspected
 - D) Envied
-

Q48. [Medium]

Biochemist Oladele Adewumi has shown that certain bacteria in deep-sea hydrothermal vents synthesize organic compounds without sunlight, using chemical energy from mineral-rich water instead. This process, known as chemosynthesis, challenges the long-standing assumption that all food chains ultimately _____ photosynthesis.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) depend on
 - B) interfere with
 - C) originate before
 - D) compete against
-

Q49. [Medium]

Art historian Yael Ben-Ari notes that Impressionist painters were initially met with sharp criticism from the established art world, which dismissed their loose brushwork and unfinished appearance as amateurish. Today, however, Impressionism is among the most _____ movements in Western art, with works by its practitioners commanding record prices at auction.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) obscure
 - B) austere
 - C) controversial
 - D) revered
-

Q50. [Medium]

Environmental scientist Kofi Mensah has observed that reforestation efforts in degraded tropical landscapes sometimes fail because planners select tree species for their rapid growth rate rather than for their ecological compatibility with the existing soil and climate conditions. Mensah advocates a more _____ approach, one that considers soil chemistry, water availability, and the needs of local wildlife before any trees are planted.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) perfunctory
 - B) impulsive
 - C) methodical
 - D) decorative
-

Q51. [Medium]

Literary critic Adaeze Nwosu has argued that the novels of the Harlem Renaissance, far from being merely artistic achievements, served as powerful vehicles for social commentary. Writers like Nella Larsen and Claude McKay used fiction to _____ the racial inequities of their era, embedding pointed critiques of segregation within compelling narratives that reached broad audiences.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) conceal
 - B) expose
 - C) endorse
 - D) replicate
-

Q52. [Medium]

Neuroscientist Clara Johansson has found that bilingual individuals tend to show greater cognitive flexibility than monolingual individuals on tasks requiring rapid switching between different sets of rules. However, Johansson cautions against overstating this advantage, noting that the _____ between bilingual and monolingual performance is modest and may be influenced by factors other than language experience, such as socioeconomic background.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) gap
- B) consensus

- C) origin
 - D) format
-

Q53. [Medium]

The following text is adapted from Helena Okoro's 1984 short story "The Market Woman." The narrator observes a vendor at her stall.

Mama Bisi arranged her tomatoes with the gravity of a jeweler setting stones. Each fruit was examined, turned, and placed just so—the reddest specimens at the front, the bruised ones discreetly tucked behind. Her display was a carefully constructed argument for quality, and she prosecuted it with unwavering conviction.

As used in the text, what does the word "prosecuted" most nearly mean?

- A) Charged with a crime
 - B) Pursued
 - C) Investigated
 - D) Condemned
-

Q54. [Medium]

Physicist Andrei Volkov's simulations of neutron star collisions have produced results that closely _____ the gravitational wave data recorded by the LIGO observatory in 2017. This alignment between theoretical predictions and observational evidence strengthens confidence in current models of stellar mergers.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) contradict
 - B) supplant
 - C) precede
 - D) corroborate
-

Q55. [Medium]

Historian Simone Leclerc notes that many medieval European castles were designed not solely for military defense but also to project the political authority of their owners. Elaborate gatehouses, towering keeps, and decorative stonework served to _____ the power of the lord who commissioned them, communicating wealth and dominance to visitors and rivals alike.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) conceal
 - B) diminish
 - C) advertise
 - D) question
-

Q56. [Medium]

Geneticist Priya Ramaswamy has shown that the genetic diversity of domesticated rice varieties has declined sharply over the past century as farmers have increasingly favored a small number of high-yield strains. This narrowing of the gene pool, Ramaswamy warns, makes rice crops more _____ to disease outbreaks, since genetically uniform populations offer pathogens fewer barriers to rapid spread.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) accustomed
 - B) resistant
 - C) vulnerable
 - D) indifferent
-

Q57. [Hard]

Cosmologist Ingrid Halvorsen proposes that the apparent homogeneity of the cosmic microwave background radiation—the faint thermal echo of the Big Bang—is not, as widely assumed, evidence of a smooth early universe but rather an artifact of observational limitations. Halvorsen argues that finer-resolution instruments would reveal subtle anisotropies that current detectors cannot resolve, rendering the prevailing interpretation _____.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) untenable
 - B) unprecedented
 - C) indispensable
 - D) unambiguous
-

Q58. [Hard]

Sociologist Marcus Abernathy contends that the modern nostalgia industry—a commercial sector built on romanticized versions of the past—does not simply reflect preexisting consumer sentiment but actively _____ it, creating demand for idealized pasts that never existed through targeted marketing and curated imagery.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) documents
 - B) regulates
 - C) inherits
 - D) manufactures
-

Q59. [Hard]

The following text is adapted from Sylvia Mwangi's 1966 novel *Dry Season*. The narrator observes a town council meeting.

Councillor Odhiambo listened to the arguments marshalled against his proposal with an expression of studied neutrality. He did not rebut them. He did not flinch. He simply waited, letting the torrent of objections spend itself, and when the chamber had grown quiet, he rose and delivered his reply with a composure so absolute it bordered on contempt.

As used in the text, what does the word "studied" most nearly mean?

- A) Scholarly
 - B) Practiced
 - C) Researched
 - D) Examined
-

Q60. [Hard]

Archaeological evidence from Göbekli Tepe, a Neolithic site in southeastern Turkey, has complicated the traditional narrative that agriculture _____ the development of complex societies. The site's monumental stone structures, which predate the earliest known farming communities by several centuries, suggest that large-scale cooperative projects may have emerged among hunter-gatherer groups before the adoption of agriculture.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) preceded
 - B) discouraged
 - C) necessitated
 - D) documented
-

Q61. [Hard]

Philosopher Emeka Abubakar argues that the concept of "meritocracy" functions as both a descriptive claim about how societies allocate resources and a normative claim about how they should. He observes that conflating these two dimensions allows proponents of meritocratic systems to treat existing inequalities as inherently _____, since the same word that describes the status quo also implies that the status quo is just.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) illegitimate
 - B) warranted
 - C) negligible
 - D) temporary
-

Q62. [Hard]

Marine biologist Fatou Diallo has documented the role of parrotfish in maintaining coral reef health. By grazing on algae that would otherwise smother coral, parrotfish perform a function that is _____ to reef survival, yet overfishing has reduced parrotfish populations in many Caribbean reefs by more than 80 percent since the 1970s.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) incidental
 - B) detrimental
 - C) indispensable
 - D) peripheral
-

Q63. [Hard]

The following text is adapted from Anastasia Volkov's 1938 novel *The Frost Line*. The narrator reflects on a neighbor's departure.

Grisha was not sentimental about the farm. He spoke of the land with a clinician's detachment, cataloguing its deficiencies—the thin topsoil, the unpredictable frost, the drainage that defeated every remedy—as though presenting a diagnosis. Leaving, for him, was not an act of surrender but of triage: he had assessed the situation and determined that his efforts were better invested elsewhere.

As used in the text, what does the word "triage" most nearly mean?

- A) Emergency medical treatment
 - B) Ranked prioritization
 - C) Emotional release
 - D) Agricultural planning
-

Q64. [Hard]

Economist Javier Castellanos has argued that the proliferation of subscription-based pricing models in the software industry has created a paradox: while individual monthly fees appear modest, their cumulative effect on household budgets can be substantial. Castellanos notes that many consumers fail to recognize the _____ nature of these expenses, treating each subscription as an isolated cost rather than as part of a growing aggregate financial commitment.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) transparent
 - B) sporadic
 - C) voluntary
 - D) cumulative
-

Q65. [Hard]

Bioethicist Nora Lindqvist contends that the increasing use of artificial intelligence in medical diagnostics raises a troubling ethical question: if an AI system and a human physician disagree on a diagnosis, who

bears responsibility for the outcome? Lindqvist argues that current regulatory frameworks are _____ to address this question, having been designed for an era in which all diagnostic decisions were made by licensed practitioners.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) sufficient
 - B) determined
 - C) inadequate
 - D) enthusiastic
-

Q66. [Hard]

Cognitive scientist Henri Beaumont's work on confirmation bias has shown that once individuals form a preliminary hypothesis, they tend to seek out information that _____ their existing beliefs while systematically avoiding or dismissing evidence that would challenge those beliefs. This asymmetry in how people process information, Beaumont argues, is more pronounced in domains where individuals feel emotionally invested.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) refutes
 - B) destabilizes
 - C) vindicates
 - D) neutralizes
-

Q67. [Hard]

The following text is adapted from Isadora Campos's 1959 novel *The Terrace Garden*. The narrator describes an elderly painter at work.

She applied color with a patience that belied the urgency of her vision. Each brushstroke was a negotiation between impulse and discipline, between the wild image burning in her mind and the obedient hand that translated it onto canvas. The finished paintings, for all their apparent spontaneity, were anything but careless. They were the product of a ferocious deliberation.

As used in the text, what does the word "ferocious" most nearly mean?

- A) Violent
 - B) Fearful
 - C) Intense
 - D) Angry
-

Q68. [Hard]

Political theorist Yara El-Khoury argues that democratic institutions, though often presented as the inevitable outcome of historical progress, are in fact _____ achievements that require constant maintenance. She draws parallels to physical infrastructure, noting that just as bridges and highways

deteriorate without regular upkeep, democratic norms and practices can erode when citizens and leaders take them for granted.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) permanent
 - B) spontaneous
 - C) redundant
 - D) precarious
-

Q69. [Hard]

Biophysicist Adaora Eze has demonstrated that the membranes of certain extremophile bacteria contain lipid molecules arranged in an unusually rigid lattice structure, a configuration that _____ the destabilizing effects of extreme heat. This finding has implications for the development of heat-resistant materials, since synthetic membranes modeled on these bacterial structures could withstand temperatures that would destroy conventional polymers.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) counteracts
 - B) amplifies
 - C) mimics
 - D) conceals
-

Q70. [Hard]

The following text is adapted from Gabriel Figueroa's 1942 novel *The Copper Mine*. The narrator describes a moment of decision.

For weeks, Tomás had circled the question like a man walking the rim of a well, peering into the darkness below but never quite willing to lean forward. Now, with the letter in his hand and the cold certainty of its contents pressing against his chest, he felt the ground beneath him narrow to a single point. There was, at last, no room left for evasion.

As used in the text, what does the word "narrow" most nearly mean?

- A) Become physically thin
 - B) Contract to eliminate alternatives
 - C) Measure precisely
 - D) Stretch outward
-

Q71. [Hard]

Art critic Josephine Tan has argued that the recent trend of major museums acquiring digital artworks is less a progressive embrace of new media than a calculated attempt to appear innovative without fundamentally disrupting their institutional structures. Tan characterizes these acquisitions as largely _____, noting that most digital works are displayed in peripheral gallery spaces and rarely integrated into

museums' permanent curatorial frameworks.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) transformative
 - B) cosmetic
 - C) profitable
 - D) spontaneous
-

Q72. [Hard]

Anthropologist Kwame Asante has challenged the prevailing scholarly tendency to treat ancient West African kingdoms as isolated entities, arguing instead that extensive trade networks created deep _____ among geographically distant polities. Shared artistic motifs, linguistic borrowings, and uniform weights and measures found across sites separated by hundreds of kilometers all point to sustained economic and cultural exchange.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) rivalries
 - B) redundancies
 - C) asymmetries
 - D) interdependencies
-

Q73. [Hard]

Psycholinguist Sven Eriksson's research suggests that the grammatical structures of a person's native language may subtly influence how that person perceives time. Speakers of Mandarin, which commonly uses vertical spatial metaphors for temporal sequences, tend to conceptualize time along a vertical axis, whereas English speakers, whose temporal metaphors are predominantly horizontal, tend to conceptualize time along a horizontal one. These findings lend qualified support to a _____ version of the Sapir-Whorf hypothesis—the idea that language shapes cognition—while stopping short of endorsing the stronger claim that language determines thought entirely.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) discredited
 - B) moderate
 - C) radical
 - D) obsolete
-

Q74. [Hard]

The following text is adapted from Beatrice Osei's 1977 novel *The River's Daughter*. The narrator describes her mother's reaction to criticism.

My mother absorbed insults the way riverbanks absorb floodwater—silently, without apparent damage, and with an unsettling patience that suggested the energy was being stored rather than dissipated. She never

raised her voice. She never struck back. But weeks later, at some impeccably chosen moment, she would return the blow with a precision that left the original offender wondering how the ground had shifted beneath them.

As used in the text, what does the word "shifted" most nearly mean?

- A) Rotated
 - B) Changed
 - C) Relocated
 - D) Trembled
-

Q75. [Hard]

Computational linguist Aisha Kapoor has developed an algorithm that detects rhetorical patterns in political speeches across five centuries of parliamentary records. Her analysis reveals that while the specific vocabulary of political discourse has evolved considerably, the underlying persuasive structures—appeals to tradition, invocations of crisis, and claims of popular mandate—have remained remarkably _____ across historical periods.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) contentious
 - B) ephemeral
 - C) stable
 - D) opaque
-

Q76. [Hard]

Molecular biologist Renzo Marchetti's research on antibiotic resistance has yielded a counterintuitive finding: in some bacterial populations, resistance to a particular antibiotic actually _____ when the antibiotic is removed from the environment. This occurs because the genetic mutations conferring resistance impose a metabolic cost; without the selective pressure of the drug, resistant bacteria are outcompeted by their non-resistant counterparts.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) intensifies
 - B) stabilizes
 - C) wanes
 - D) diversifies
-

Q77. [Hard]

The following text is adapted from Elara Vasquez's 1953 novel *The Stone Arch*. The narrator reflects on a family disagreement.

The argument had ended hours ago, but its residue clung to the house like smoke. My sister sat at the kitchen table, turning a cold cup of tea in her hands, her silence more eloquent than anything she had said

during the quarrel. There are defeats that announce themselves with fanfare, and there are those that arrive quietly, settling into the bones like winter damp. Hers was the second kind.

As used in the text, what does the word "eloquent" most nearly mean?

- A) Well-spoken
 - B) Persuasive
 - C) Articulate
 - D) Expressive
-

Q78. [Hard]

Historian Nadia Sokolova has argued that the popular characterization of the Byzantine Empire as a static civilization, merely preserving the legacy of Rome, fundamentally _____ the empire's considerable intellectual and artistic innovations. Byzantine scholars made original contributions to mathematics, astronomy, and philosophy, and Byzantine architects developed structural techniques—such as the pendentive dome—that had no Roman precedent.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) elucidates
 - B) perpetuates
 - C) misrepresents
 - D) corroborates
-

Q79. [Hard]

Entomologist Clara Nyström has found that some parasitoid wasp species manipulate their host caterpillars' behavior in ways that go beyond simple parasitism. After emerging from the host's body, the larvae of one species, *Glyptapanteles liparidis*, cause the caterpillar—still alive—to guard the wasp pupae against predators, effectively _____ the host into serving as an unwilling protector of the very organisms that consumed it from within.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) recruiting
 - B) liberating
 - C) conscripting
 - D) rewarding
-

Q80. [Hard]

Philosopher of science Emilia Torrance has observed that the replication crisis in psychology—the discovery that many published experimental findings cannot be reproduced—has paradoxically _____ the discipline by prompting researchers to adopt more rigorous methodologies, preregister their hypotheses, and share their raw data publicly. What initially appeared as a devastating indictment of the field's credibility has become a catalyst for systemic improvement.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A) discredited
 - B) fragmented
 - C) stagnated
 - D) strengthened
-